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UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT MEETS KUWAIT'S MINISTER OF INTERIOR

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan meets Sheikh Fahad Yousef Saud Al Sabah, First Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Interior of Kuwait, at Qasr Al Bahr in Abu Dhabi. The meeting touched on the close fraternal ties between UAE and Kuwait and ways to strengthen cooperation across various fields to serve mutual interests and support the development aspirations of both nations.

UAE launches digital platform for buying and selling trademarks

Platform targets 20% growth in trademark registrations within first year of operation

DUBAI

BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

The UAE has unveiled the Middle East's first digital platform for buying and selling trademarks, the Ministry of Economy and Tourism announced. The TM Market Place, launched on Tuesday, enables trademark owners to list, trade and monetise their registered marks through a secure online environment.

The platform became fully operational on its launch day, with the ministry's goal to boost the market's attractiveness to brands by 20 per cent within the first year, according to Abdullah Bin Touq Al Marri, Minister of Economy and Tourism.

34,234

national, international trademarks registered since January 2025

"TM Market Place is a unique initiative for the UAE and the region, enabling owners of trademarks registered in the UAE to list and trade their trademarks within a secure and transparent environment and connecting them with investors and entrepreneurs," Al Marri said at the launch event in Abu Dhabi.

Addressing a gap

The platform addresses a gap in the UAE's business landscape, where many companies and individuals hold legally protected trademarks that remain commercially underutilised.

The initiative was developed through collaboration between

the Ministry of Economy and Tourism and the UAE Government Leaders Programme.

TM Market Place is expected to particularly benefit small and medium enterprises and family businesses by converting trademark value into usable financial assets. The platform will also lower barriers for international investors and entrepreneurs looking to enter the UAE market by providing access to ready-made or promising trademarks.

From January to early November 2025, the UAE registered 34,234 national and international trademarks, with the first half of the year seeing 19,957 registrations — a 129 per cent increase compared to the same period in 2024.

The Ministry said it would oversee the platform to ensure compliance with national and international intellectual property laws. Sales and transactions will be limited to national and international trademarks registered in the UAE.

New UAE foster care law lets expats sponsor children

Non-Emirati couples and single women can adopt children of unknown parentage

ABU DHABI

BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor

The UAE Government has recently introduced amendments to the law on the foster care and guardianship of children of unknown parentage, issued under Federal Decree-Law No. (24) of 2022 concerning the rights of children "of unknown parentage" and children "under care." The new amendments allow non-Emirati couples and single women to adopt children of unknown parentage and children under care.

Federal Decree-Law No. 12 of 2025, published in the latest issue of the Official Gazette, amends key provisions of the 2022 law regulating the care of

children of unknown parentage. The updated rules specify detailed requirements for applicants and strengthen oversight over foster care arrangements. The new amendment stipulates that any married couple, each over the age of 25, may apply to foster a child, regardless of nationality or religion. Additionally, women aged 30 and above may apply to become guardians, with no upper age limit.

Previously restricted

Previously, adoption (foster care) was restricted to married Emirati Muslim couples and Emirati Muslim women aged between 30 and 50. Unlike adoption, under the current 2022 law, the child does not acquire inheritance rights if the guardians pass away, nor can the child become part of the family lineage.

Guardians must demonstrate the financial ability to support the child and sign an agreement not to alter the child's identity or beliefs.

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UK to impose 'tourist tax' on visitors to cities

LOCAL MAYORS GIVEN POWERS TO LEVY TAXES ON VISITING TOURISTS

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Mayors in England will now be able to impose a new "tourist tax" on visitors under new budget measures announced yesterday, a move that could increase travel expenses for UAE residents heading to London and other major cities. The policy is part of a wider fiscal package that also caps tax benefits on salary-sacrificed pension contributions and expands revenue-raising powers for local authorities.

The government has launched a consultation on how the tourist levy will operate, including whether it will be set as a fixed nightly rate or a percentage of accommodation costs. It was also reported widely that the tax is expected to be set at about £2 (Dh9.40) per night, covering both hotel stays and Airbnb-style rentals.

Percentage-based model

London may adopt a percentage-based model, which would raise more from premium hotels. City Hall estimates a levy could generate at least £200 million a year, funding local services and tourism infrastructure. Mayor Sadiq Khan has lobbied the Treasury for devolved tax powers, saying the measure "will directly support London's economy."

Other English city mayors, including Liverpool's Steve Rotherham, have pushed for similar authority. Rotherham said cities like Barcelona and Paris already

OTHER TAKEAWAYS

- National Insurance (NI) and income tax thresholds will be frozen for an extra three years beyond 2028.
- The two-child benefit cap will be scrapped from April 2026.
- 'Mansion tax' charges will see properties worth more than £2m charged £2,500 annually, and properties worth more than £5m charged £7,500.
- A new electric vehicle excise duty will amount to 3p per mile for electric cars and 1.5p for plug-in hybrids.
- Reforms to the Motability scheme will remove luxury vehicles.

raise millions through comparable taxes and that UK cities have been "expected to compete on a global stage without the basic tools that other places take for granted."

Hospitality operators warned the levy may curb demand and add to households' travel costs. "This is a tax on the British seaside holiday, the city break, those visiting family and friends," UK Hospitality Chief Executive Kate Nicholls told Bloomberg.

For UAE travellers, any approved levy would add a small but noticeable cost to stays in London during peak seasons. The final design, rate and rollout timeline will be set after the consultation concludes.

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